

Radiation Therapist

By: Lexi



What is a Radiation Therapist?

Radiation therapists are a specialized healthcare professional who treats cancer and other diseases by administering targeted radiation to patients, primarily using linear accelerators



What are two schools in California that offer courses for this degree/profession?

Orange Coast College offers a Radiologic Technology program in which you can earn an Associate of Science degree. CC San Francisco also offers an Associate of Science in Radiation Therapy Technology. Both programs are accredited by the Joint Review Committee on Education in Radiologic Technology (JRCERT).

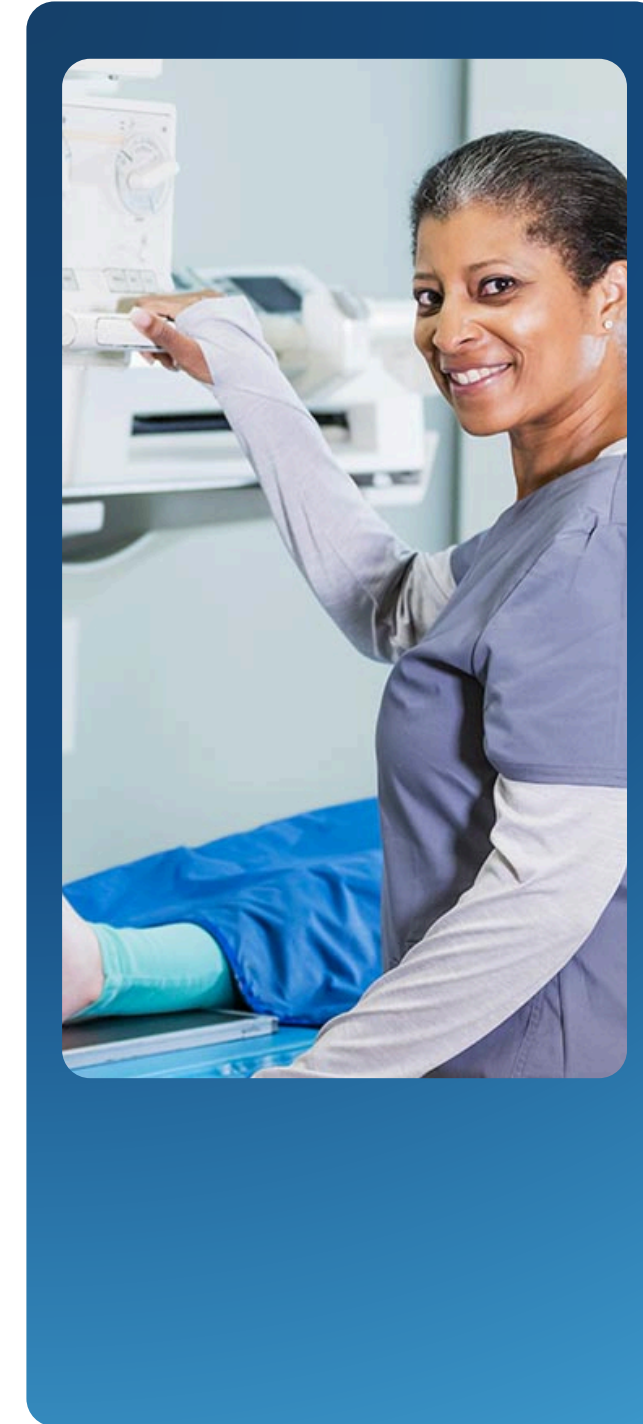


How long will it take to complete the program/schooling?

At City College of San Francisco, the radiologic technology program takes about 2 years to complete (after prerequisites). At Orange Coast College, the program also takes about 2 years to complete (after prerequisites).

Example prerequisites:

- HS diploma or GED
- Minimum GPA of 2.5–3.0
- Math, English, Biology



What type of degree/certificate do you earn?

At both schools, you can earn an Associate of Science (AS) degree, then complete a Radiation Therapy certificate.



How much will it cost to complete your schooling?

City Collage of San Francisco

- Tuition: about \$3,358
- Books & supplies: about \$2,000
- Equipment/fees (uniforms, labs, background check, etc.): about \$1,250+
- ARRT exam: \$225

Total: about \$6,800+

Orange Coast College

- Tuition: about \$3,000–\$4,000
- Books & supplies: about \$1,500–\$2,000
- Equipment/fees (uniforms, labs, background check, etc.): about \$500–\$1,000
- ARRT exam: \$225

Total: about \$5,600



Summary of Both Radiation Therapy Programs



	City College of San Francisco (CCSF)	Orange Coast College (OCC)
 School	City College of San Francisco	Orange Coast College
 Program Length (After Prerequisites)	About 2 years	About 2 years
 Degree/Certificate Earned	Associate of Science (AS) degree + Radiation Therapy Certificate	Associate of Science (AS) degree + Radiation Therapy Certificate
 Prerequisites (Example)	• HS diploma or GED • Minimum GPA of 2.5–3.0	• HS diploma or GED • Minimum GPA of 2.5–3.0
 Estimated Cost Breakdown	• Tuition: about \$3,358 • Books & supplies: about \$2,000 • Equipment/fees (uniforms, labs, background check, etc.): about \$1,250+ • ARRT exam: \$225	• Tuition: about \$3,000–\$4,000 • Books & supplies: about \$1,500–\$2,000 • Equipment/fees (uniforms, labs, background check, etc.): about \$500–\$1,000 • ARRT exam: \$225
 Total Estimated Cost	About \$6,800+	About \$5,600

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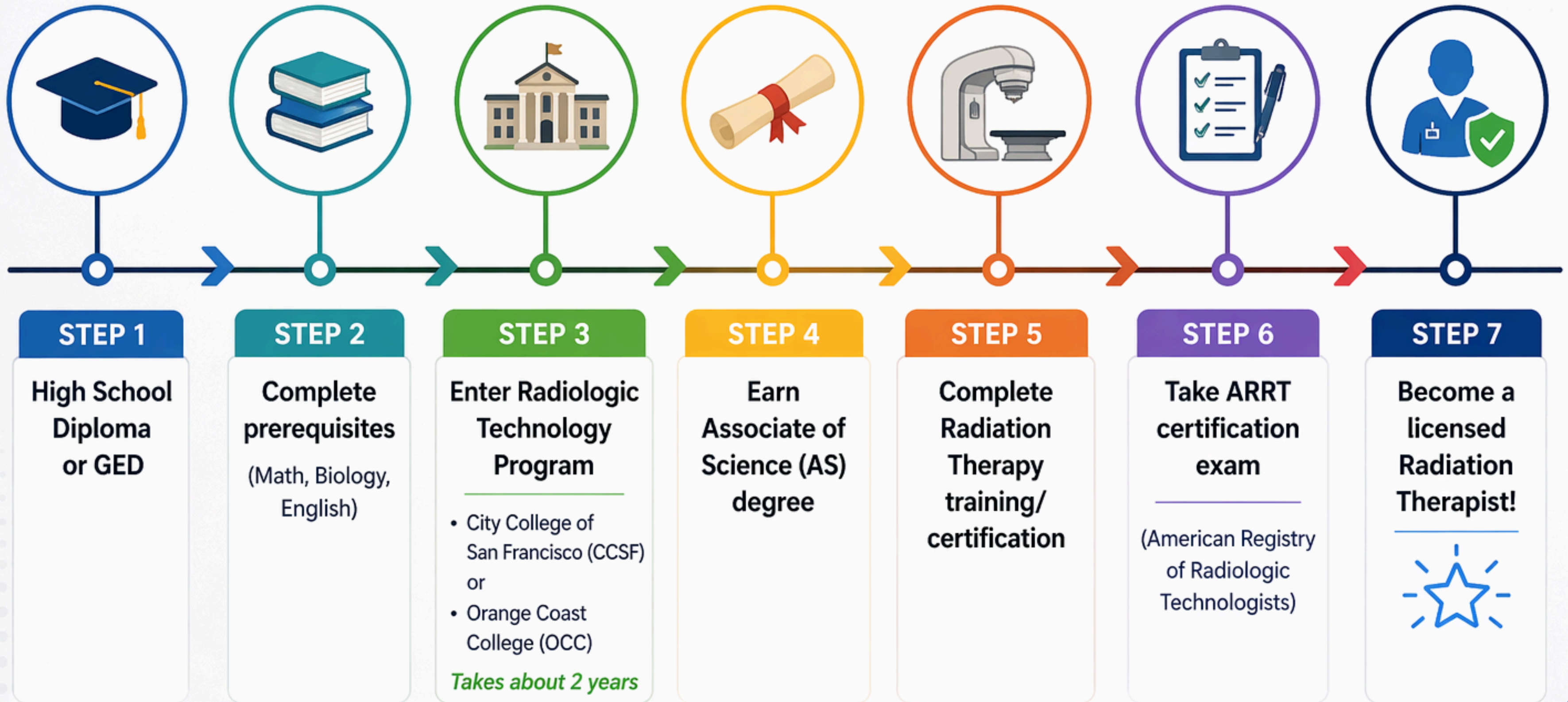
Is there a state/national certification test needed to complete the certification?

Yes, you would need to take the ARRT (American Registry of Radiologic Technologists) exam. It costs about \$225 to take. The test includes 200–300 questions about entry-level knowledge in medical imaging or radiation therapy. It is considered moderately difficult, so you need to study and practice to pass.



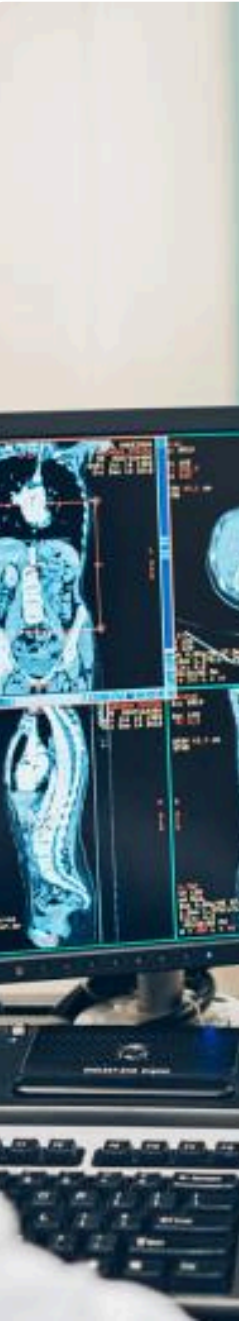
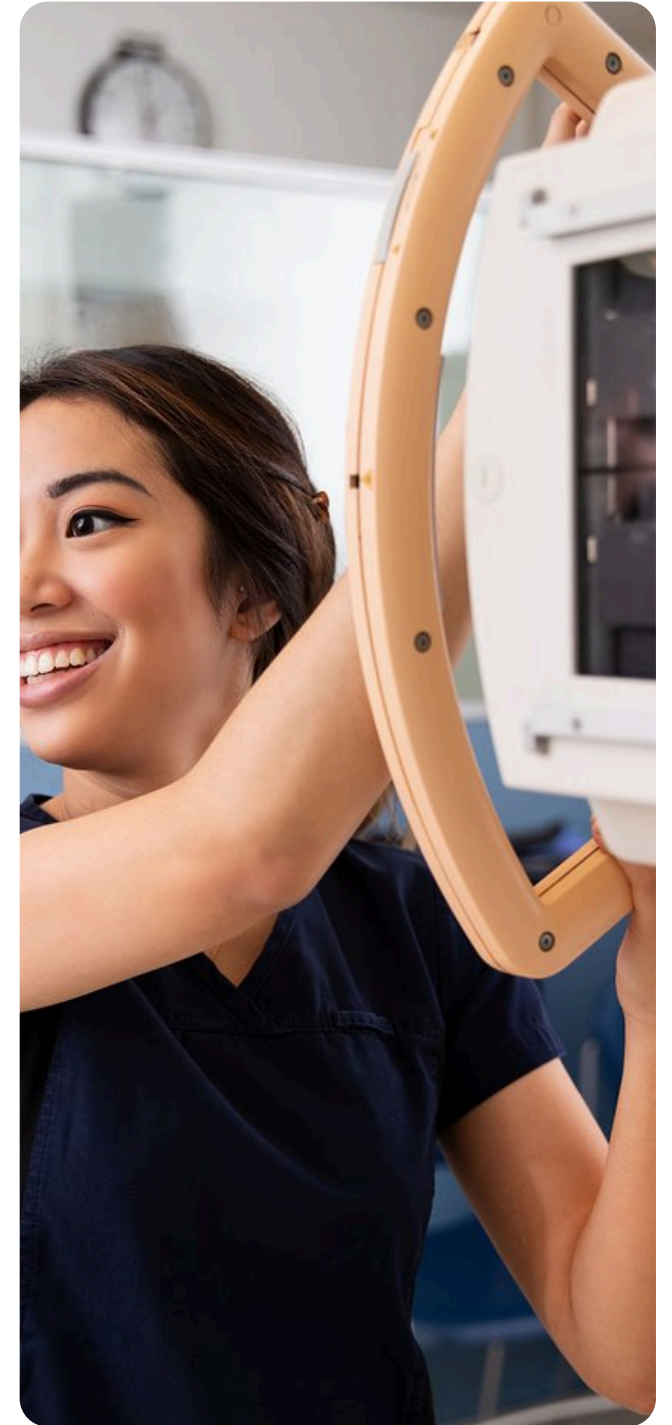
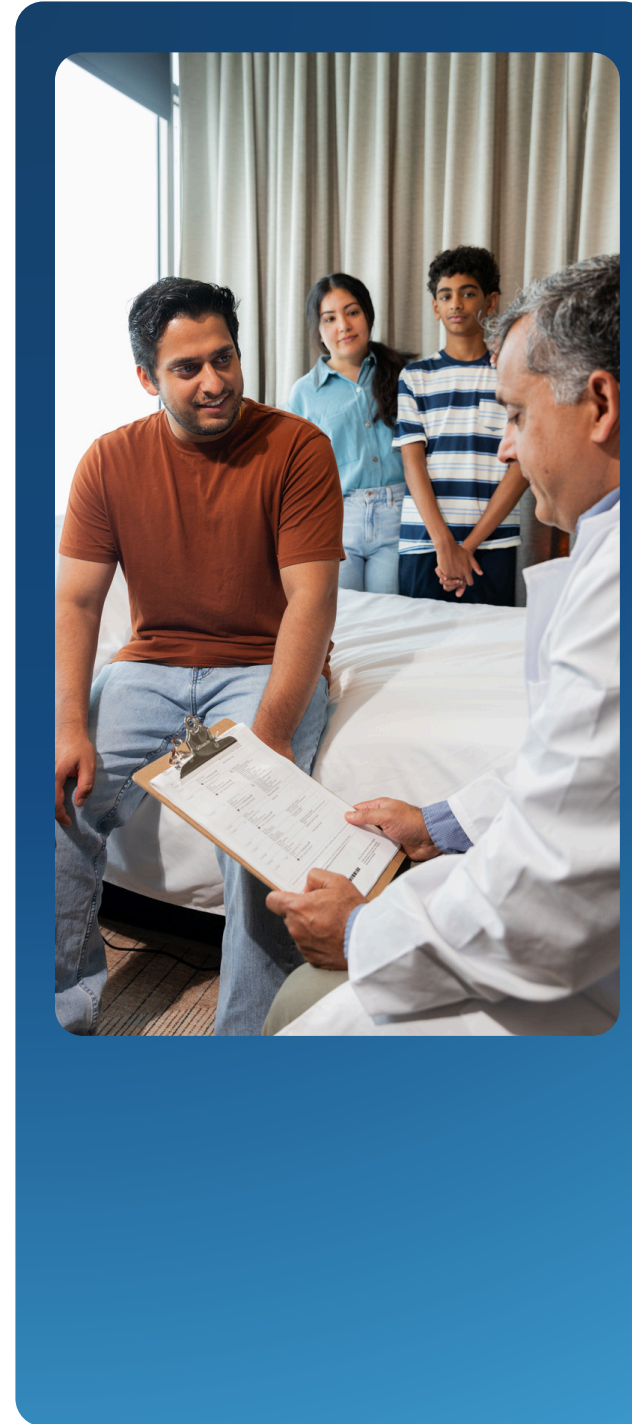
EDUCATION PATH

RADIATION THERAPIST



What types of jobs are available?

In this profession, you can work as a Radiation Therapist or a Radiologic Technologist. Some people can also become MRI Technologists, Dosimetrists, or Radiology Supervisors.

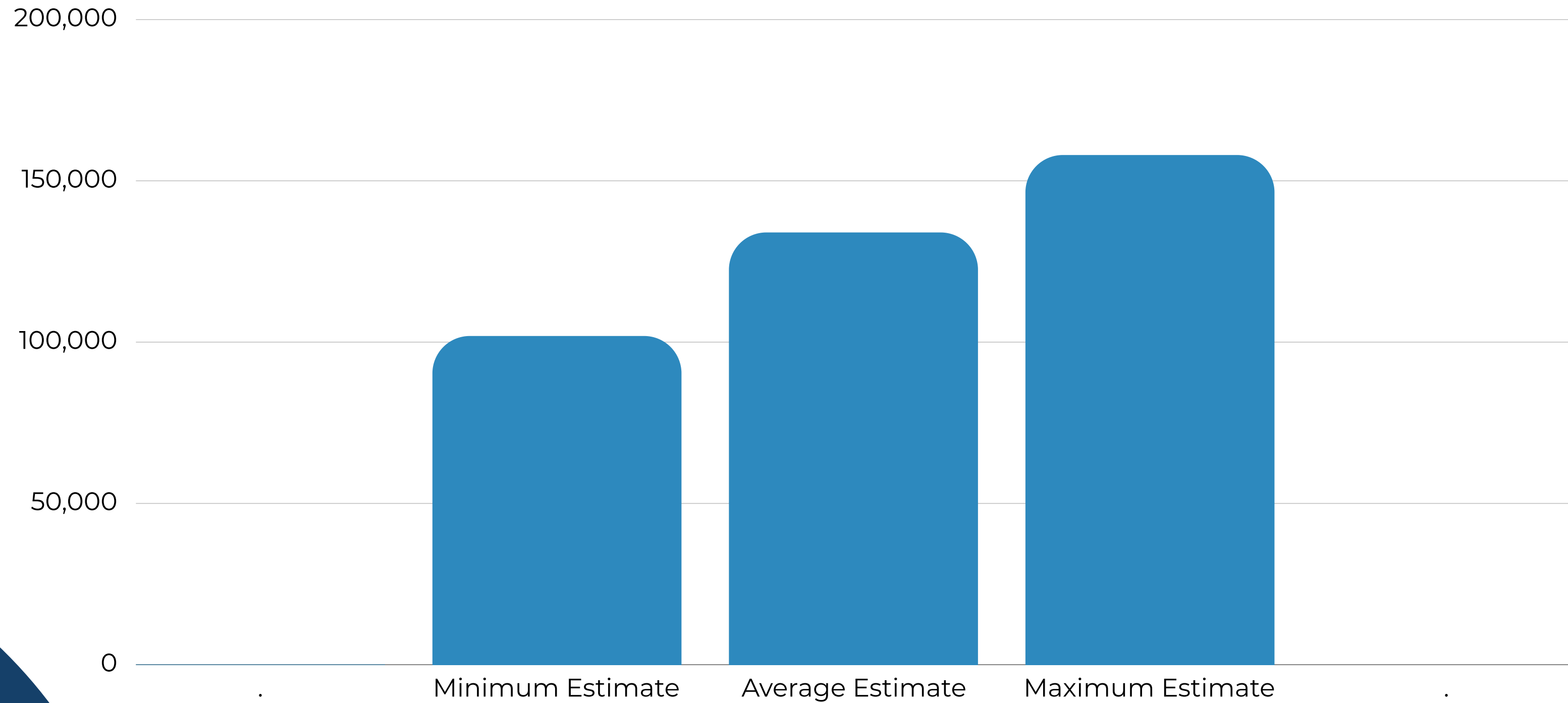


Where can you work?

Radiation therapists usually work in hospitals, cancer centers, and outpatient clinics. These places have special equipment to treat patients with cancer using radiation. They work closely with doctors and nurses to ensure patients receive safe, accurate treatment.



Yearly Salary in California as a Radiation Therapist



Everyday Tasks

1. Prepare patients for radiation treatments
2. Operate radiation machines
3. Position patients accurately for treatment
4. Monitor patients during procedures
5. Follow strict safety procedures
6. Keep detailed treatment records
7. Work with doctors and oncology teams



Benefits of Choosing This Career

- High pay (over \$100K as yearly salary in California)
- Help people fight cancer
- Strong demand for healthcare jobs
- Job stability (healthcare is always needed)
- Work in clean, modern environments
- Opportunities to advance (like supervisor or specialist)
- Feel proud of helping patients every day

